

Recruitment & Safer Hiring Framework

SECTION 1: POLICY, LEGAL BASIS & PERSONNEL FILE REQUIREMENTS

This framework governs all recruitment, selection, and onboarding at Chosanta Management. **No person shall commence work with children or young people prior to completion of all mandatory pre-employment checks.** This is non-negotiable and cannot be waived due to staffing pressures.

Legislative basis: **National Vetting Bureau (Children and Vulnerable Persons) Acts 2012–2016 · Children First Act 2015 · Child Care (Standards in Children's Residential Centres) Regulations 2018 (S.I. 674/2017) · HIQA National Standards 2018 (Standard 6) · CORU (Health and Social Care Professionals Act 2005)**

⚠ CORU Registration — Critical Deadline: The Social Care Workers Register opened 30 November 2023. From **1 December 2025**, the title "Social Care Worker" becomes a **legally protected designation** in Ireland. Only CORU-registered professionals may use this title. All staff in Social Care Worker roles must be registered or actively applying before appointment.

1 MANDATORY PERSONNEL FILE CONTENTS

The following must be on file for every staff member before commencement and maintained throughout employment. HIQA/Tusla ACIMS inspectors will audit personnel files:

#	Document Required	Standard / Source	Verified?
1	Completed application form / CV — full employment & education history; all gaps explained	Tusla ACIMS / HIQA Std 6	☐
2	Photo ID — state-issued only (valid Passport or Driver's Licence)	Tusla ACIMS	☐
3	Current Garda Vetting Disclosure — National Vetting Bureau (obtained before start date)	NVB Acts 2012–2016	☐
4	Overseas police clearance — required if lived abroad for 6+ consecutive months	Tusla ACIMS	☐
5	Minimum 3 written references including most recent employer (verified by phone/email — evidence on file)	Tusla ACIMS	☐
6	Evidence of relevant qualifications — Level 7+ NFQ in Social Care / Applied Social Studies / related field	S.I. 674/2017 Reg.16	☐
7	CORU registration certificate (Social Care Workers) or application reference number	CORU / Health & Social Care Professionals Act 2005	☐
8	Children First e-Learning certificate (mandated person training)	Children First Act 2015	☐
9	Signed job description and contract of employment	Employment legislation	☐
10	Completed induction checklist (signed by PIC)	HIQA Standard 6	☐
11	Probationary review records	HIQA Standard 6.3	☐
12	Vetting re-disclosure date tracker (re-vet every 3 years)	NVB Acts 2012–2016 / Tusla	☐

2 RECRUITMENT & SELECTION PROCESS

Stage	Action Required	Documented?
1. Vacancy identified	PIC completes workforce needs assessment; role profile confirmed against Statement of Purpose	☐
2. Advertise	Role advertised with clear requirements (qualifications, CORU registration, vetting); safeguarding statement included in all adverts	☐
3. Shortlisting	Shortlisting criteria documented; minimum 2 staff involved; notes retained	☐
4. Interview	Structured interview; minimum 2 panel members; scored questions; notes retained for 12 months; at least 1 question on child protection values	☐
5. Pre-employment checks	All checks in Section 1 completed and verified before offer confirmed	☐
6. Offer & onboarding	Written offer conditional on checks; induction scheduled; supervision contract signed within 2 weeks	☐
7. Probation	3-month and 6-month probationary reviews conducted and signed	☐

Recruitment & Safer Hiring Framework

SECTION 2: NEW STAFF CHECKLIST, REFERENCE VERIFICATION & PROBATION

3 NEW STAFF PRE-COMMENCEMENT CHECKLIST

Staff Name: _____		Role: _____		Start Date: _____	
Item	Date Completed	Verified By	On File?		
Application form / CV received & reviewed			☐		
Photo ID sighted and copied			☐		
Garda Vetting Disclosure received (NVB)			☐		
Overseas clearance (if applicable)			☐ N/A ☐ Yes		
Reference 1 received & verified			☐		
Reference 2 received & verified			☐		
Reference 3 (most recent employer) received & verified			☐		
Qualification certificates received & verified with awarding body			☐		
CORU registration confirmed / application reference noted			☐		
Children First e-Learning certificate on file			☐		
Signed contract of employment issued			☐		
Induction programme scheduled			☐		
Supervision contract signed			☐		
Added to Training Matrix			☐		
Vetting re-disclosure date entered in tracker (3 years from issue)			☐		

PIC Approval — Cleared to Commence: _____ Date: _____

4 REFERENCE VERIFICATION LOG

Tusla ACIMS requires evidence that references were **actively verified** — not merely received. Phone verification is preferred. Record all verification attempts:

Referee	Organisation	Relationship	Method	Date Verified	Verified By	Outcome
Ref 1			☐ Phone ☐ Email			☐ Positive ☐ Concerns
Ref 2			☐ Phone ☐ Email			☐ Positive ☐ Concerns
Ref 3 (most recent employer)			☐ Phone ☐ Email			☐ Positive ☐ Concerns

Any concerns raised by references: ☐ None ☐ Yes — detail below and escalate to Director before appointment:

5 PROBATIONARY REVIEW SCHEDULE

Review	Due Date	Date Completed	Outcome	Reviewer Signature
3-Month Review			☐ Pass ☐ Extend ☐ Fail	
6-Month Review (Confirmation)			☐ Confirmed ☐ Extended ☐ Not Confirmed	

6 VETTING RE-DISCLOSURE TRACKER

Staff Name	Role	Original Vetting Date	Re-Vetting Due	Re-Vetting Completed	Status

Legislative Basis: National Vetting Bureau Acts 2012–2016 · Children First Act 2015 · S.I. 674/2017 (Reg.15 & 16) · HIQA National Standards 2018 (Standard 6) · CORU / Health & Social Care Professionals Act 2005

CORU Note: Social Care Worker title legally protected from 1 December 2025. All SCW roles require CORU registration from that date.

Ref: CM-RSH-001 | Version 1.0 | May 2025 | Review: Annual | **Policy Owner:** Director / Registered Provider